

» IPL PLAYER OF THE FORTNIGHT

MATCHES

5

Runs

155

Average

31.00

Strike Rate

209.45

Stats as of May 4, 2025

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V

aibhav Suryavanshi made a swashbuckling entry into the Indian Premier League record books with his 38-ball 101 against Gujarat Titans. At 14 years and 32 days, Suryavanshi became the youngest player to score a century in T20 cricket. The Rajasthan

Royals batter reached the three-figure mark in just 35 deliveries, making it the second-fastest hundred in IPL history – only Chris Gayle has struck a quicker century (30 deliveries).

Suryavanshi's innings helped the Royals chase down a daunting target of 210 runs and banished the ghosts of their previous pursuits against Delhi Capitals, Lucknow Super Giants and Royal Challengers Bengaluru, where they had collapsed from comfortable positions.

Expectations were modest when Suryavanshi was picked by RR for Rs 1.10 crore at the mega auction. Then just 13 years old, he was the youngest in the pool, and few expected significant game time for the teenage prodigy.

He had shown glimpses of his brilliance during his 34-run knock on debut against LSG. But the century in only his third match was convention-defying, making a strong case that even a 14-year-old can carve a place for himself in T20 cricket's grandest stage. The southpaw plundered an in-form pace attack comprising Mohammed Siraj, Ishant Sharma and Prasidh Krishna. However, the highlight came against debutant Karim Janat, whom he clobbered for 30 runs in a single over. Tweakers Rashid Khan and Washington Sundar fared little better, conceding 29 runs from 13 deliveries against him.

Suryavanshi showcased his on-side range during the innings, scoring over 50 per cent of his runs between midwicket and fine leg. Nine of his 11 sixes came on the on-side. It took a searing yorker from Prasidh to dismiss him in the 12th over, but RR had already amassed 166 runs by then.

For a side languishing at the foot of the points table, Suryavanshi's emergence has been a rare silver lining in the Royals' season.

The teenager was quickly reminded of cricket's boom-and-bust nature with two single-digit scores following his hundred. He has a long road ahead, but knowing that his century will live on in IPL folklore should offer warmth through the journey.

TEEN
TYPHOON

R. V. MOORTHY